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DOWNFALL OF THE RAJAPAKSAS

Through nepotism and poor policy decisions, the Rajapaksas have nearly ruined Sri Lanka's economy. Now, a nation burning in rage wants the last of them out

By Chandani Kirinde in Colombo

How the mighty have fallen. For the once politically formidable Rajapaksa family in Sri Lanka, the end seems nigh. Their spectacular reversal of political fortunes, triggered by an unprecedented downturn in the economy due to mismanagement, corruption and nepotism, has been swift, but not surprising.

Just two and a half years ago, in November 2019, Gotabaya Rajapaksa was elected president by an overwhelming majority. It was followed by a landslide victory for his Sri Lanka People's Party (SLPP) in the general election in August 2020. It guaranteed him a two-thirds majority in parliament and helped him instal his older brother Mahinda as prime minister. But the two top posts in the country didn't satisfy the Raj-